



AQUINO, SEAN XANDER B.

BSCS-3A

When the groupings were announced, I felt excited and nervous at the same time because I wanted to be grouped with competent people I could also get along with. Then, when I saw who my groupmates were, I was overjoyed—not only could I rely on them to do their tasks, but I was already friends with them, so our group dynamics and prospects looked very strong, and I wasn't worried about our success.

As we brainstormed what idea/application we should build, I pitched my idea, and they pitched theirs. Ultimately, they chose mine because they found it compelling and "mind-blowing." My only worry was: could we actually pull this off? I knew, as the one who had thought of the idea, that it could very well be the cause of our group's downfall—doing something beyond the instructions and far outside our comfort zone.

As we built the application, they tasked me with being the project manager, overseeing everything being worked on. Then came the greatest challenge our group faced: two of us (me—the AI and API engineer—and the Data Engineer) didn't have stable internet connection due to a recent typhoon, so only our UI/UX designer had reliable internet. This posed a serious danger of us not finishing the application, because I—as both project manager and Lead AI/API engineer—couldn't properly test whether our application was really fetching the necessary data from the API due to the unstable connection. It also placed a heavy burden on the shoulders of our UI/UX designer, Joseph, who had to develop the frontend and fix all the compatibility issues. We wouldn't have pulled this off without Joseph's sacrifice, help, and stepping up. I am truly thankful, from the deepest part of my heart, that they became my groupmates.



ATIENZA, LAWRENCE

BSCS-3A

My first view of my group was full of excitement and great relief. I had struck the right balance: I had smart and skillful teammates and the ones I liked at the same time. I knew that it would work since our dynamism was good at the beginning. During our brainstorming session, one of us, Sean, came up with a brilliant ambitious idea of Lakb.ai- something we all quickly joined forces with. I was concerned about taking on such an assignment that was this much out of our comfort zone.

Our cooperation was at once brought into play. The biggest challenge was nothing related to the integration of AI, the Flet framework; it was raw logistics. Sean and I have had a recent typhoon that has taken down stable internet. As the technical heads, we were caught flat footed as we could not effectively test the key data-retrieval systems. The weight of the whole project was strained by our UI/UX designer who was named Joseph. He not only stood up, but he lifted us, and struggled to make it work, and to put together the front end. We would not have pulled this off without the near-sacrifices of Joseph, and his assistance in this bad time. I feel deeply grateful to my teammates who are brilliant, strong and hardworking.



ORIAS, MARK JOSEPH C.

BSCS-3A

As the UI/UX Engineer, my role was supposed to be focused on designing the app's interface. However, things didn't go as planned. When a typhoon hit and affected my teammates' internet connection two weeks before the deadline, I had to step up and take on most of the workload to finish the project on time.

I ended up doing everything—UI/UX design, implementing features, security, database integration, and authentication. Honestly, it was overwhelming at first. YouTube became my best friend during this period. From short tutorials to those 3-hour long videos, I watched everything I could find. Reading the framework documentation also helped a lot. I realized that instead of coding everything from scratch, there were already pre-built components I could use, which saved me so much time.

Throughout the development, I also discovered new tools that made my work easier—things I didn't even know existed before starting this project. These tools really streamlined the process.

The hardest part was definitely integrating the cloud database, authentication, and Google Sign-In since I wasn't familiar with the tech stack yet. (*Trial and error talaga*)

Despite the challenges, I'm thankful to my groupmates. Sean stayed up late when the internet was better, and Kuya Rence solved the logout function Sean and I couldn't figure out which made this project successful.